

Study Questions: Learning (Fiber & Flow)

1. How does gauge swatching function as active learning in the Active Inference framework? What kind of evidence does it generate?
2. Explain yarn substitution as a form of generative model transfer. What properties must the crocheter's model predict for a successful substitution?
3. Describe the mental library of materials that experienced crocheters carry. How is this library organized, and how does it function as a Bayesian prior?
4. Why do crocheters often say their best lessons came from their worst projects? Connect this to the role of large prediction errors in model updating.
5. How does social learning in crochet circles accelerate individual model building? What are the advantages and limitations of learning from others' experiences?
6. Compare how a beginner and an expert approach an unfamiliar yarn. What prior models does the expert bring that the beginner lacks?
7. How does the crocheter's mental model of cotton evolve from their first encounter to their hundredth project? Describe the model at each stage.
8. What role does trial and error play in learning yarn properties? Is it possible to learn everything about a fiber from reading without touching?
9. How does blocking a finished piece for the first time with a new fiber type update the crocheter's generative model? What predictions are tested?
10. Describe a situation where a crocheter's learned model of a yarn brand changes (e.g., when a manufacturer changes their formula). How does the model update?
11. How does learning to crochet with one fiber type (e.g., acrylic) create expectations that must be revised when switching to another (e.g., wool)?

12. Why is yardage estimation a learned skill? How does experience with different project types improve yardage predictions?
13. How do pattern reviews and project pages on crafting platforms function as shared learning repositories? What information transfers most effectively?
14. Describe the learning curve for a new stitch technique with a familiar yarn versus a familiar technique with a new yarn. Which produces more prediction error?
15. How does the concept of fiber burn testing represent a deliberate learning strategy? What makes it different from passive learning through use?
16. Why might a crocheter keep a yarn journal or stash database? How does this external record support the internal generative model?
17. How does dyeing your own yarn change the learning relationship with materials? What new dimensions of the model must be developed?
18. Describe how learning transfers between knitting and crochet. What parts of the material model are shared, and what must be learned anew?
19. How does the experience of frogging and re-crocheting a section contribute to learning? Is the second attempt informed by prediction errors from the first?
20. If you could design the ideal learning sequence for a new crocheter, what order of material experiences would build the strongest generative model?